Event Planning Template · Expert version

An event planning template organises everything needed to run an event: tasks on a timeline, owners, a budget tracker and a vendor list, so nothing is forgotten on the day.

How to use this template

1. Set the event's goal, audience, date and budget.
2. Work back from the event date and assign each checklist task an owner.
3. Book the venue and key vendors early.
4. Track spend on the Budget tab as quotes and invoices arrive.
5. After the event, gather feedback and record lessons learned.

Tips

- Book venues and speakers first: they set the date.
- Keep a 10% contingency.
- Have a run-of-show for the day.
- Use an event calendar for promotion.

Dashboard (sample data)

Field	Value	Count
Owner	All	1
Owner	Event lead	2
Owner	Marketing	2
Owner	Ops	1
Owner	Programme lead	1
Status	Not started	5
Status	In progress	1
Status	On hold	0
Status	Blocked	0
Status	Done	1

Checklist · Event: Customer summit · Date: 25 May 2026

Weeks before	Task	Owner	Due date	Status	Notes
12	Set goals, audience and budget	Event lead	2 Mar 2026	Done	
10	Book venue	Event lead	16 Mar 2026	In progress	Two options
8	Confirm speakers	Programme lead	30 Mar 2026	Not started	
6	Open registration	Marketing	13 Apr 2026	Not started	
4	Order catering and AV	Ops	27 Apr 2026	Not started	
2	Send joining instructions	Marketing	11 May 2026	Not started	
0	Run event and collect feedback	All	25 May 2026	Not started	

Budget · Track estimated versus actual spend

Item	Category	Estimated ($)	Actual ($)	Variance ($)	Vendor	Paid?
Venue hire	Venue	6,000	6,000	0	City Hall	Yes
Catering	Food	4,500		4,500		No
AV and streaming	Tech	3,000		3,000		No
Speaker travel	People	2,000		2,000		No
Total		15,500	6,000	9,500		